

Title: For how soul crushing losing games are, how come winning doesn't even make up for a quarter of that feeling?

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

For somebody who's played on and off for a good 8 seasons, I still don't know how to cope with losing games. I don't flame, I don't run it down, I'm not an overly optimistic andy, but I try to keep it together. I'm trying to improve at the game focusing on specific areas that are slightly difficult to quantify progress on (wave management, trading, roaming, jungle tracking, map awareness).

But no matter what I do, or how hard I try, in the end, when the defeat screen comes out, it always feels like everything I've ever done is for naught. I just die a little bit inside each time, and I know there's a lot to learn from, my mechanical misplays, my suboptimal choices, not punishing the enemy when I find the opportunity, giving enemies opportunities to punish me, I look at the replay and I see the mistakes, and I think that I learn from it, and yet, if I lose the next game, I feel that any progress I've ever made just got flushed down into the sewer.

I have a sub 50% winrate, and it probably has permanently dampered my confidence in playing ranked. Even though I won the last game I played before I started typing this post, it feels like I still don't remember the last time I won a ranked game, ever. Although I thought that I know how to get carried and how to carry when given the opportunity, I can't quite replicate it enough to even hit a 50% win rate, so do I even really know those things? Winning doesn't make me feel anything. The games aren't even memorable. But losing sure does make me feel like shit. I can remember every

"what if" that might have just changed the outcome. There's only "bad" and "neutral" for me. How do I go find the "good"?

So, for the folks out there who just improved slowly and never let losses destroy you, what have you been doing? I find it really hard to keep going while dragging that emotional anchor along. If you are one of those people who started at sub 50% winrate, but turned it around and improved, I really need to hear from you.

[my opgg](<https://na.op.gg/summoner/username=aizera>)

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 1144]

I enjoy 90% of my time playing league because I don't think about the game as being only winning and losing. Approach the game as a series of experiences. "winning" and "losing" are 3 second screens you see at the end of 15-40 minute experiences. You need to find enjoyment in the components. You won a trade, enjoy it. You got a kill, enjoy it. You got a baron, enjoy it. It feels like you're focusing too much on the destination and not on the journey. I can lose a game and still feel good that I hit a sick 4 man Oriana ult. This will keep your mental intake which is the best way to climb, strong and healthy mental.

[Comment 2 | Score: 78]

Progress and improvement in all activities, not just league, tends to plateau at a certain point. After you learn all the basic information/basic things the remaining concepts are obviously harder to pick up.

This is especially true in league where a lot of the finer points are small and hard to see along with have near 0 feedback on whether or not you're improving in that aspect. This is exacerbated by being a team game where your performance doesn't necessarily lead to you winning on top of having near useless solo performance metrics, with regards to non-pro play, which is a deviation from most sports.

It's important to remind yourself and keep your mind focused that you're not trying to reach short term goals but the long term goal of self improvement and climbing over a full season or year.

Nobody becomes the best at what they do overnight. Sure when you're picking up something new you might start at a different starting point but at the end of the day to reach the highest tiers of anything everybody has to put in dedicated work over time.

[Comment 3 | Score: 70]

There's a lot of really cool psych research on this kind of topic! Basically to summarize like 30 years of research in a sentence: punishment is far more punishing than rewards are rewarding. For example, eating a bad bit of seafood leads to a life-long aversion, but having a really nice lobster doesn't leave quite the same impression.

On the other hand, there are some ways of making unenjoyable and enjoyable experiences more impactful. Most of the techniques things like mindfulness / flow states but all of that boils down to a basic process of paying attention to what you're doing. In the context of league, I'd recommend

focusing on individual parts of your gameplay. Maybe that's Macro knowledge, maybe it's tricky mechanics with a particular champion. Whatever it is, when you go into a game, focus entirely on that one thing. Consider improvement at that one thing your win, regardless of the end-screen. You'll tend to come out of your games feeling a lot better, even if you don't win (and you'll probably win more often anyways).

[Comment 4 | Score: 21]

That's all about attitude.

If you approach every game expecting a win, then getting the win is just normalcy. Par for the course. Nothing special.

But if you approach every game expecting a win, each loss is maximum failure. That sucks.

If you approach each game with the idea that you want to do your best, with the realization that in a team game your personal best might not translate to a win every game, you'll still have something to play for and a goal to reach without win/lose being the only factor for you.

Or just learn to abandon expectations entirely.

[Comment 5 | Score: 14]

It's already set on here, but you've gotta set different goals than just wins or losses. What is the weakest part of your game right now (CS, trading, map awareness, champion knowledge)? Pick an aspect to improve on and set a goal over the course of 10-20 games. So for example: Currently I have 100 CS at the 20 minute mark, let's focus on CS'ing, especially farming mid-late game, and see if I can get that score up to 120 over the next 10 games. Then go back and check your

progress. If you failed, figure out why. If you succeeded, pick your next goal: maybe you're an ADC but don't know jack about what supports you synnergize with, so play 10 normal games as a different support and see which kits make sense with your main.

But you have to view climbing as just a BYPRODUCT of this improvement. If literal wins or losses are your only goals, then winning slowly morphs into your EXPECTATION and your only possible outcomes are "met expectations" or "failed." That's a mindset destined for depression.